Ishan Shah

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VP of Engineering | Infrastructure & Platform Engineering | AI-First Transformation, SRE/Reliability, Developer Platforms & Data Infrastructure

SUMMARY

Engineering leader with 15+ years building and scaling infrastructure and platform organizations — cloud infrastructure, developer platforms, data infrastructure, reliability engineering, and observability. I lead the AI-first transformation of engineering, identifying where AI changes how software is built and operated, and turning it into measurable productivity. I've operated one of AWS's largest-scale distributed data services at 99.99% reliability, run multi-cloud platforms across AWS, GCP, and Azure with strong cost discipline, and championed SRE and operational excellence. I define technical strategy that delivers business outcomes, develop engineering leaders, partner with product, security, and executive leadership, and contribute in the open-source community. Deep regulated-industry and security background (ISO 27001, SOC 2).

EXPERIENCE

CruxOCM Inc. — VP of Engineering / Head of Automation (reporting to the CTO) · Feb 2025 – Present

- **Infrastructure & platform strategy:** Define and execute the vision for a distributed engineering organization spanning platform, infrastructure, DevOps, SRE, security, and quality; own cloud infrastructure, internal developer platforms, and data systems, and partner with the CEO/CTO, product, and security on strategy alignment and business outcomes.
- **AI-first transformation of engineering:** Lead the AI-first transformation — identifying where AI changes how software is built and operated — via an org-wide Gemini Enterprise rollout, standardized Cursor/Claude Code + GitHub Copilot, AI-driven CI/CD, and production AI agents (GCP ADK) and MCP servers, and shipped IAH, a multi-tenant B2B SaaS AI platform sold to external business customers.
- **AI control plane (in build):** Architecting a production-hardened AI control plane on GKE with a Kuma service mesh (mTLS) — an Agent Gateway (AuthN/AuthZ, guardrails, agent/MCP registration, path & model routing, budgets, audit), a LangGraph supervisor orchestrator with a human-in-the-loop approval gate, MCP backends with egress allow-listing and short-lived credentials, and Langfuse observability (traces, tokens, cost, evaluations) — the platform substrate for safe, governed AI across engineering.
- **Cloud infrastructure & developer platforms:** Standardized Kubernetes as the control plane across AWS, GCP, and Azure with Terraform and GitOps; built internal developer platforms with self-service, "paved-road" tooling that lets teams build, deploy, and operate at scale.
- **Reliability (SRE) & observability:** Championed SRE and operational excellence — observability on the Grafana LGTM stack (Loki/Grafana/Tempo/Mimir) / OpenObserve with PagerDuty, SLOs, and blameless incident response and RCA at 99.99% uptime.
- **Data infrastructure, cost & leadership:** Own data platforms and ~$2M cloud spend with >$200K saved through cost optimization; hire, mentor, and develop engineers and leaders, fostering a culture of technical excellence; spearheaded ISO 27001 and SOC 2 (audit ownership).

Amazon (AWS Redshift) — Lead Systems Engineer · Dec 2016 – Dec 2022

- Owned the build, CI/CD, release ecosystem, and test tooling for Redshift — one of AWS's largest-scale, globally distributed data services — including the CI/CD servers and fully automated build/deploy across all AWS-supported regions, at high availability.
- Led the team that designed and shipped a Bors-style automated merge queue, gating integration on the exact merge candidate (not just the feature branch) — eliminating broken-mainline incidents and unblocking developer velocity org-wide.
- Added metrics-driven reporting on pipeline health and developer productivity, making bottlenecks visible and driving continuous improvement across the developer workflow.

Insulet Corporation (FDA-regulated medical devices) — Sr. Cloud Engineering Manager · Dec 2022 – Feb 2025

- Led cloud and data-product teams (25–30 engineers) across platform, DevOps, developer productivity, and performance engineering; partnered with the VP of Engineering on multi-year roadmaps and quarterly OKRs.

- Built a performance and load-testing framework (Locust, Python) on EKS/AWS (25% improvement); operated highly available Jenkins on EKS/EFS (99.9% uptime) and cut deployment errors 15%.
- Owned end-to-end CI/CD with gating and one-button deploy (Jenkins, Python, Gradle); implemented SBOM generation and regulated change control for supply-chain security.

Prosper Marketplace (regulated fintech) — Lead DevOps Engineer · Jan 2015 – Dec 2016

- Rolled out org-wide CI/CD with Jenkins and containerization with Docker; managed Artifactory artifact/versioning, SonarQube static-analysis quality gates, and a Hadoop cluster on AWS (EMR) for large-scale data processing.

Pivotal Software — Member of Technical Staff · Sep 2011 – Jan 2015

- Managed CI infrastructure and agents; migrated Perforce to Git with enforced branching/merge policy; automated Coverity static analysis and code-coverage; built dynamic provisioning of Linux environments on AWS and vCloud.

OPEN SOURCE

UniClaw · github.com/uniclaw-labs/uniclaw

- Architected and shipped UniClaw, an open-source AI agent platform — Claude-powered agents on a FastAPI (Python) backend and a React / TypeScript app, with a pluggable provider/tool registry (27+ integrations) and a security-first design (OAuth2 with scoped JWTs, Fernet-encrypted secrets, non-root containers); 4,400+ automated tests across a polyglot codebase (Python, TypeScript, Rust). Also publish an open-source Lever MCP server.

EDUCATION

- M.S., Software Engineering, San Jose State University (2011)
- B.E., Computer Engineering, Gujarat University (2009)

SKILLS & TOOLS

- **Infrastructure & Platform Engineering:** Cloud infrastructure; internal developer platforms & platform-as-a-service; data infrastructure; reliability engineering (SRE) & observability; cloud-native architecture
- **AI-First Engineering:** AI-driven transformation of the software lifecycle; AI agents (GCP ADK) & MCP servers; RAG / retrieval (Vertex AI); enterprise AI rollout (Gemini Enterprise); AI-assisted development (Cursor, Claude Code, GitHub Copilot); MLOps/LLMOps
- **Cloud & Reliability:** AWS, GCP, Azure (multi-cloud); Kubernetes (EKS/GKE/AKS); Terraform; Docker; GitOps; SLOs & incident management; 99.99% reliability; cloud cost optimization (FinOps)
- **Data & Distributed Systems:** Large-scale distributed systems; data platforms (AWS Redshift, BigQuery, Hadoop); databases (PostgreSQL, MySQL, Oracle, DynamoDB); CI/CD (GitHub Actions, Jenkins, Bazel, Gradle)
- **Security & Compliance:** ISO 27001 / SOC 2 (audit ownership); SBOM & static-analysis scanning; access control; regulated industries
- **Leadership & Strategy:** Technical strategy & business outcomes; developing engineering leaders & high-performing teams; executive communication; product/security/executive partnership; roadmaps & OKRs; ~$2–3M budget; open-source community engagement